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Tofen

Ketotifen 0.025% w/v
Eye Drops

DESCRIPTION AND COMPOSITION
Pharmaceutical form(s)
Tofen: Eye drops, solution in a 5 mL bottle. A Clear, colorless solution.

Active substance
Ketotifen hydrogen fumarate

Tofen: One mL contains 0.345 mg of ketotifen hydrogen fumarate corresponding to 0.25 mg of ketotifen.
Certain dosage strengths may not be available in all countries. Not all presentations may be available locally.

Active Moiety
Ketotifen.

Excipients
Tofen: Benzalkonium chloride, Glycerol (E422), Sodium hydroxide (E524), Water for Injections.
Pharmaceutical formulations may vary between countries.

INDICATIONS
Treatment of signs and symptoms of allergic conjunctivitis in patients aged 3 years and above.

DOSAGE AND ADMINISTRATION
Dosage
Use in adults
One drop of Tofen eye drops into the conjunctival sac twice a day.

Use in children (aged 3 years and above)
One drop of Tofen eye drops into the conjunctival sac twice a day. Safety and effectiveness in pediatric patients below the age of 3 years have not been established.

Geriatrics
No dosage adjustment is required in patients above 65 years of age.

Renal impairment
No dosage adjustment is required in patients with renal impairment.

Hepatic impairment
No dosage adjustment is required in patients with hepatic impairment.

Method of administration
Tofen: The contents and dispenser remain sterile until the original closure is broken. To avoid contamination do not touch any surface with the dropper tip. The dropper tip should also not come into contact with the eye as this may cause injury to the eye.
If Tofen eye drops are used concomitantly with other eye medications there must be an interval of at least 5 minutes between the two medications.

Mode of administration: Ophthalmic

CONTRAINDICATIONS
Known hypersensitivity to ketotifen or to any of the excipients.

WARNINGS AND PRECAUTIONS
Tofen: The multidose formulation of Tofen eye drops contains benzalkonium chloride as a preservative, which may be deposited in soft contact lenses; therefore, Tofen eye drops should not be instilled while the patient is wearing these lenses. The lenses should be removed before application of the drops and not reinserted earlier than 15 minutes after use.
All eye drops preserved with benzalkonium chloride may possibly discolor soft contact lenses.

Driving and using machines
Any patient who experiences blurred vision or somnolence (See section ADVERSE DRUG REACTIONS) should not drive or operate machines.

ADVERSE DRUG REACTIONS
Adverse drug reactions are listed by MedDRA system organ class. Within each system organ class, the adverse drug reactions are ranked by frequency, with the most frequent reactions first. Within each frequency grouping, adverse drug reactions are presented in order of decreasing seriousness. In addition, the corresponding frequency category for each adverse drug reaction is based on the following convention: very common, common, uncommon, rare, very rare.

Table 1 Adverse drug reactions

Immune system disorders Uncommon: Hypersensitivity.
Nervous system disorders Uncommon: Headache.
Eye disorders Common: Punctate keratitis, corneal erosion, eye irritation, eye pain. Uncommon: Vision blurred (during instillation), dry eye, eyelid disorder, conjunctivitis, photophobia, conjunctival haemorrhage.
Gastrointestinal disorders Uncommon: Dry mouth.
Skin and subcutaneous tissue disorders Uncommon: Rash, eczema, urticaria.
General disorders and administration site conditions Uncommon: Somnolence.

Adverse drug reactions from post marketing experience (Frequency not known)
The following post marketing events have also been observed:

Ocular adverse drug reactions
Localized allergic/hypersensitivity reaction, including mostly contact dermatitis, eye swelling, and eyelid pruritis and oedema.

Systemic adverse drug reactions
Facial swelling/oedema (in some cases associated with contact dermatitis) and exacerbation of pre-existing allergic conditions such as asthma and eczema.

INTERACTIONS
If Tofen eye drops is used concomitantly with other eye medications there must be an interval of at least 5 minutes between the two medications.
The use of oral dosage forms of ketotifen may potentiate the effect of CNS depressants, antihistamines and alcohol. Although this has not been observed with Tofen eye drops, the possibility of such effects cannot be excluded.

Pregnancy and lactation
Women of child-bearing potential
There are no special recommendations for women of child-bearing potential.
Pregnancy
There are no adequate data from the use of ketotifen eye drops in pregnant women.
Systemic levels after ocular administration are much lower than after oral use. When prescribing to pregnant women, the benefits to the mother should be weighed against the risk to the fetus.
Breast-feeding
Although animal data following oral administration show excretion into breast milk, topical administration to humans is unlikely to produce detectable quantities in breast milk.
Tofen eye drops can be used during breast-feeding.
Fertility
There is no data available on the effect of ketotifen hydrogen fumarate on fertility in humans.

OVERDOSAGE
Tofen: Oral ingestion of the contents of a 5 mL bottle would be equivalent to 1.25 mg of ketotifen which is 60% of a recommended oral daily dose for a 3 year old child. Clinical results have shown no serious signs or symptoms after oral ingestion of up to 20 mg of ketotifen.

CLINICAL PHARMACOLOGY
Mechanism of action (MOA) and Pharmacodynamics (PD)
Ketotifen is a histamine H1-receptor antagonist. In vivo and in vitro

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ketotifen inhibits the release of mediators (e.g histamine, leukotrienes and prostaglandins, and PAF) from cells involved in immediate type I allergic reactions (mast cells, eosinophils, basophils and neutrophils).
Ketotifen also decreases chemotaxis, activation and degranulation of eosinophils. Increased cAMP levels by phosphodiesterase inhibition may contribute to the cell stabilizing effect of ketotifen.
Pharmacokinetics (PK)
Absorption
Plasma levels of ketotifen after repeated ocular administration for 14 days were in most cases below the limit of quantitation (20 pg (picograms)/ml).
Biotransformation and elimination
After oral administration, ketotifen is eliminated biphasically with an initial half-life of 3 to 5 hours and a terminal half-life of 21 hours. About 1% of the substance is excreted unchanged in the urine within 48 hours and 60 to 70% as metabolites. The main metabolite is the practically inactive ketotifen- N-glucuronide.

INCOMPATIBILITIES
The multidose formulation of Tofen eye drops contains benzalkonium chloride as a preservative, which may be deposited in soft contact lenses and may possibly discolor soft contact lenses (see section WARNINGS AND PRECAUTIONS).

Pharmaceutical Precaution
Store below 30°C, away from light. Keep out of the reach of children.

Unopened bottle: 24 months.
After first opening: The content should be used within 28 days. Closed the bottle immediately after use. Do not store above 25°C.

Commercial Pack
Tofen 0.025% Eye Drops: Dropper bottle containing 5 ml of sterile solution. Each ml contains Ketotifen Hydrogen Fumarate 0.345 mg/ml equivalent to Ketotifen 0.25 mg.

BEXIMCO PHARMA
Manufactured by
BEXIMCO PHARMACEUTICALS LTD.
126 Kathaldia,Auchpara Tongi,1711 Gazipur, Dhaka, Bangladesh.
0000000000 030423

Product Registration Holder
Vitamode Sdn Bhd
55, Lorong Sempadan 2,
11400 Ayer Itam, Penang,
Malaysia

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